

Meural Canvas II

Meural Canvas II are wireless, high-end digital photo frames that feature “enhanced” dual-band 802.11ac Wi-Fi radios from Netgear, Alexa support, and an optional subscription to digital artworks. Unveiled at IFA 2019, the Canvas II is available in two sizes – 21.5 inches and 27 inches. The display technology, which is dubbed “TrueArt”, is capable of displaying 16.7 million colours. There’s also a front-facing ambient light sensor which auto-adjusts the brightness of the display. Speaking of the display, it is an anti-glare, 1080p AHVA display.



If you choose not to go for the subscription we mentioned above, you can upload your own digital snapshots via an SD card or through the USB port located on the side of the frame. Specific images can even be scheduled to appear during different preset times of the day. If you want to change the picture right then, simply swipe on the frame with your fingertip or ask Alexa to fire up a new art piece. There’s also an accompanying app or web portal from where you can easily control the frame.

The frame itself is powered by a quad-core 1.8GHz ARM Cortex-A17 processor, has 8GB of storage and 4GB of DDR3 RAM. It even has an ethernet port! The latest iteration of the product is reportedly designed to use 45 per cent less power when compared to previous Canvas models. The Canvas II can be mounted in portrait or landscape mode, and for an additional \$50 you get a swivel mount which allows users to change orientation on the fly.

Bose Frames

The Bose Frames aren’t your run-of-the-mill sunglasses. Nope. These nifty Frames combine three functionalities into one - the first, and most obvious being, well, they’re a pair of sunglasses. What’s surprising is that they are also a pair of wireless headphones and have audio AR features! Sporting a price tag of ₹21,900 with the option of non-polarised (₹1,990) or polarised (₹2,990) lenses, these pair of sunglasses pack a tiny Bose audio system right within the temples. This transforms them into a pair of wireless headphones which come equipped with a microphone and a multi-function button situated on the right temple for power, pairing, Assistant, calls and other commands.



These revolutionary Frames come into two designs - Alto and Rondo. The former sports a squarish and angled design while the latter is smaller and round. Weighing a mere 45 gms, the glasses are rated to block out up to 99 per cent of UV rays. Coming to the audio AR functionality, the glasses don’t provide any visual AR abilities, like in movies... but they do enhance audio with the AR input. The glasses have inbuilt trackers which partner with your phone’s GPS to work out your location and provide you with applications which, right now, mainly focus around navigation and entertainment. The Bose Frames sport a respectable battery life of 3.5 hours. While the glasses aren’t exactly smart glasses, they have some fun applications.

DemerBox DB2 Bluetooth speaker

The DemerBox DB2 is a Bluetooth speaker. No, not an ordinary one, but a nearly indestructible Bluetooth speaker. The thing that aids its durability and ruggedness is a military-grade Pelican 1300 case, which the speaker is built into. Unfortunately, indestructibility doesn’t come cheap and the speaker is priced at \$300. There are two 3 inch woofers built into the case with a rechargeable Li-Ion battery that also doubles up as a charging station for your smartphone or tablet. The speaker has been put



through the wringer by several reviewers who have concluded that the speaker is nearly life-proof. It delivers a massive 40 hours of battery life, and comes with an upgraded audio system from its previous iteration. It is an ideal companion for trips or outdoor parties. To add to this, it also supports multi-speaker pairing and can be connected to 6 additional speakers. The speaker, in addition to being waterproof, also floats!